

Roberto Sforza

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Education, Courses and Certificates:

- ❖ **Master's Degree in Global Management and Politics** • LUISS Guido Carli University, Rome, Italy • (Expected Graduation Year: 2027)
- ❖ **Bachelor of Arts in Politics: Philosophy, and Economics (PPE)** • LUISS Guido Carli University, Rome, Italy • (Grade: 110 Summa cum Laude, attained July 14th 2025)
- ❖ **Diplôme d'Institut d'Études Politiques (Bachelor of Arts in Political Studies)** • Sciences Po Bordeaux, Bordeaux, France • (Mention "Très Bien," Note de Mémoire 19/20, attained July 10th 2025)
- ❖ **Foundations of Finance** • University of Cambridge, ACT (Association of Corporate Treasurers) • Course Certificate (Attained July 2023)
- ❖ **Investigative Process and Interrogation Methods** • LUISS Academic Gym – Professional Skills • Course Certificate (Attained January 2024)
- ❖ **Public Speaking** • LUISS Academic Gym – Soft Skills • Course Certificate (Attained January 2024)
- ❖ **UN Model Programme: Agrifood System Transformation accelerates Climate Action** • FAO - LUISS University • Course Certificate (Attained December 2023)
- ❖ **Sustainable Food Systems: An Introduction, Concept and Framework, Operationalising the Approach - Migration and Climate Change - Climate Change Negotiations for Agriculture Stakeholders** • Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) eLearning Academy • Course Certificates (Attained October 2023)
- ❖ **High School Diploma** • Liceo Scientifico Tradizionale Augusto Righi • Rome, Italy (Grade 94/100, attained July 2022)

Personal Statement:

I am a driven individual with very widespread interests and a strong passion for international relations, political philosophy, behavioural economics and even music, also focusing on psychology and its applications to different subjects and fields. My greatest quality is willpower. I am not afraid of failure, for it has been my greatest teacher. With a focus on critical and analytical thinking, problem-solving, and a fair deal of stubbornness, I am eager to undertake any challenges that life will throw at me.

Languages:

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|--|------------------------------|
| ❖ Italian Native Speaker | ❖ Spanish Proficiency |
| ❖ Full Professional English Proficiency | ❖ Intermediate French |

Expertise:

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| ❖ Academic and Report Writing | ❖ Policy Analysis |
| ❖ Critical, Analytical and Problem-Solving skills | ❖ Artificial Intelligence |
| ❖ Public Speaking and Body Language | ❖ Behavioural Economics |
| ❖ International Relations | ❖ Investigative Process and Interrogation Methods |
| ❖ Political Philosophy | ❖ Foundations of Finance |
| ❖ European Union Law | ❖ 15-years' experience in Music Theory, harmony, and melody. |
| ❖ European Politics | |

Experience:

- ❖ **ETHOS Observatory on Public Ethics** – LUISS Guido Carli University • Rome, Italy
 - **Political Philosophy Research & Project Intern** (Philosopher) • October 2025 – Present
 - **Young ETHOS Joint Managing Director** • October 2025 – Present
 - **ETHOS Member** • May 2024 – Present
- ❖ **EU Strategy, Strategic Consultancy** • Brussels, Belgium
 - **Strategic Consultancy & EU Public Policy Intern**
 - **EU Digital & Security Policy Analyst** • June – July 2023
 - **Transport & Mobility Policy Research Analyst** • June – July 2024
 - Conducted intelligence gathering and policy analysis on EU legislation and regulatory developments, producing research outputs for internal and client-facing use.
 - Worked extensively on key EU digital policy files, including the EU Artificial Intelligence Act (AIA) and the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA), monitoring negotiations and analysing implications.
 - Supported stakeholder engagement by attending meetings with representatives of EU institutions and contributing to high-level client interactions.
 - In 2024, analysed the post-European Elections policy landscape in the Transport & Mobility sector, assessing how institutional reshuffles and electoral outcomes shaped policy-making.
 - Participated in high-profile Brussels political events, strengthening situational awareness of EU politics and the strategic consultancy environment.
- ❖ **International Networking Association LUISS** • Networking Committee – **Chief of Inter-Association Communication Branch** • Rome, Italy • October 2023 – October 2024
- ❖ **Model UN Program FAO** • **Representative of Italy** • FAO Headquarters, Rome, Italy • October 2023
- ❖ **Model NATO** • **Representative of France** • LUISS University Campus, Rome, Italy • April 2024
- ❖ **LIMUN 2024** • **INTERPOL General Assembly Representative of Ecuador** • King's College, London, England, United Kingdom • February 2024

Interests:

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|----------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| ❖ Reading | ❖ Philosophy |
| ❖ Writing | ❖ Poetry |
| ❖ Politics and Economics | ❖ Ethics and Morality |
| ❖ Geopolitics and Security | ❖ Psychology |
| ❖ Languages | ❖ Personal Growth and Development |
| ❖ Music | ❖ Fitness and Sports |
| ❖ European Union | |

Projects:

❖ **In Defence of Democracy: The Worst Form of Government, Except for All the Others.** Explaining the Russia-Ukraine War by the Belligerents' Domestic Regimes. *A Liberal Analysis* • LUISS Guido Carli University, Sciences Po Bordeaux • January 2025 – June 2025

Final dissertation for the Double Degree Program in *Politics: Philosophy and Economics* and *Études Politiques* between LUISS Guido Carli and Sciences Po Bordeaux, under the mentorship, guidance and supervision of Professor Sebastiano Maffettone, greatly renowned philosopher and expert academic, and Professor Dario Battistella, leading IR scholar. This research offers a liberal analysis of the Russia-Ukraine War, interpreted not merely as a geopolitical confrontation, but as the outcome of a fundamental asymmetry between regime types.

Drawing on Interwar Idealism, Michael Doyle's Liberal Democratic Peace Theory, and Andrew Moravcsik's New Liberalism, the thesis argues that *"the war transcends the mere matters of territorial reconfiguration or historical claims, constituting a collision between two states whose internal orders are shaped by diametrically opposed philosophies of governance."* The Russian full-scale invasion of Ukraine is read as a product of the personalist and autocratic structure of the Kremlin, where *"power and policy preferences are effectively monopolized by Mr. Putin and his chosen circle of oligarchs and loyalists,"* allowing imperial nostalgia to become state action. Conversely, Ukraine is portrayed as a *quasi-democracy* whose imperfect but resilient aspiration towards Europeanisation and liberal norms opened the door to international solidarity.

The work denounces liberal democracy's structural vulnerability to internal subversion through its own procedures, advancing a robust normative stance: *"The right to vote cannot include the right to abolish the system that guarantees it [...] Strip democracy of liberalism, and all that makes it worth defending will already have been lost. It will have become a loaded gun in the hands of the mob; better to seize it before it fires."* The concluding chapter calls for an assertive and vigilant liberalism – one capable of defending itself both from within and without – echoing the spirit of militant democracy: *"Should democracy be swayed to betray its principles, to betray liberty, to strangle its parent, then it must be disciplined. For democracy can either be liberal, or be it cannot."*

The dissertation is informed by Locke's natural-rights Liberalism, Kant's Republican Cosmopolitanism, Machiavelli's cautions, and Schumpeter's Theory of Democracy; it further employs Wilsonian Idealism together with the above-mentioned frameworks of Doyle and Moravcsik, along with other influential scholars, political scientists, and philosophers such as Van den Bergh, Zakaria, Gel'man, Maffettone, Sartori and more; it finally grounds its normative defence of constitutional self-preservation in Rawls's *Reasonableness* and Overlapping Consensus, Popper's Paradoxes of Tolerance and Democracy, and Loewenstein's Militant Democracy doctrine.

❖ **Word Wars** • May 2024 – Present

Ideated and directed by Roberto Sforza and Alessandro Bruneau, Word Wars is a platform and series of events in which students, university professors, experts and guests can openly bring forward their ideas, positions and confront each other, supporting a debate without barriers and in mutual respect, so as to allow a clash of ideas that is not a clash between people, but a formative, enlightening and stimulating experience for everyone involved.

Words do not suffice to express the pride and elation in seeing what was once just an idea come to life the way it did.

This was the result of numerous people working together and of the precious collaboration with the *ETHOS* Observatory on Public Ethics and the International Networking Association at LUISS Guido Carli.

Enormous thanks go to Professor Sebastiano Maffettone for having shown immediate enthusiasm for the project, for having followed it and having participated in it since its first session, held at the Ethos Headquarters in the Luiss Guido Carli University Viale Pola Campus.

Letter of Recommendation:



To Whom It May Concern,

The undersigned Andrea Parola, managing director at EU Strategy, certifies that Roberto Sforza successfully completed two internships with us during the months of June/July in the years 2023 and 2024.

EU Strategy is Strategic Consultancy based in Brussels and has been active since 2009.

2023 Internship Period

During this period, Roberto demonstrated exceptional analytical and research skills, focusing on intelligence gathering and analysis of EU Policies and Legislation. Notably, he worked extensively on the new European Union Artificial Intelligence Act (AIA) and the Cyber Resilience Act (CRA). Roberto attended various meetings with members of the European Institutions and interacted with high-profile clients. Through these experiences, he gained invaluable insights into European Politics, strategic consultancy, EU legislation and the world of Artificial Intelligence. Additionally, Roberto had the privilege of participating in several high-profile political events, providing him with a unique perspective on the Brussels political landscape.

2024 Internship Period

In his second internship, Roberto worked on the European Transport and Mobility sector during the critical post-2024 European Elections period. This role allowed him to observe and analyse the immediate impacts of electoral outcomes and the new composition of the European Institutions on policy-making. Highly relevant to his studies, repeating such experience in the momentous post-election scenario, Roberto found this experience particularly meaningful, further enhancing his understanding of the juncture between EU politics and policy.

Throughout both internships, Roberto displayed a strong work ethic, professional demeanour, and a keen interest in European affairs. He has been a valued member of our team, contributing to our projects and learning swiftly from his experiences.

We have no doubt that Roberto will continue to excel in his future endeavours and wish him all the best.

Sincerely,
Andrea Parola